

Upgrading the Extraction of Ethanol and Isobutanol from an Aqueous Solution in the Presence of Sodium Chloride with Molecular Interaction Studies

Salal Hasan Khudaida, Serli Dwi Rahayu, Paul Figiel, Christoph Held,* and Ardila Hayu Tiwikrama*



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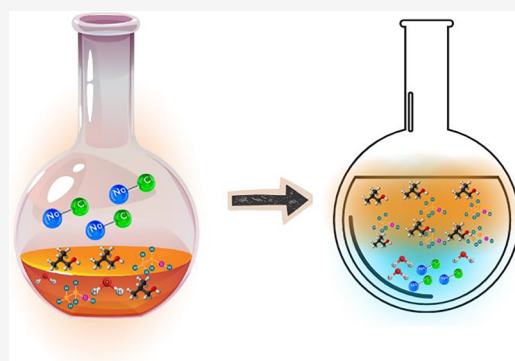


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Supporting Information

ABSTRACT: Salting-out extraction systems composed of alcohols and salts are widely used for separating valuable chemicals and fuels from aqueous solutions. Therefore, in this study, the phase equilibria of the water + ethanol + isobutyl alcohol system in the presence of NaCl were investigated. Liquid–liquid equilibrium (LLE) for the quaternary system (water + ethanol + isobutanol + NaCl) was measured at 293.15 and 313.15 K and atmospheric pressure using a jacketed equilibrium cell. The effect of NaCl concentration on LLE was studied at 5 and 10 wt %. Increasing NaCl enhanced the heterogeneous region and promoted isobutanol separation from aqueous ethanol solutions, with higher concentrations intensifying the salting-out effect and phase splitting. The electrolyte Perturbed-Chain Statistical Associating Fluid Theory (ePC-SAFT) and eNRTL models were used to satisfactorily correlate the experimental LLE data. Regression of binary interaction parameters (BIPs) showed that eNRTL required 13 parameters, whereas ePC-SAFT required only 7 parameters, demonstrating that ePC-SAFT efficiently predicts phase behavior with fewer parameters. Additionally, molecular interactions among water, ethanol, isobutyl alcohol, and NaCl were analyzed using sigma profiles. The results highlight the practical applicability of LLE data for designing separation processes and show that ePC-SAFT provides accurate predictions for electrolyte–aqueous alcohol systems when experimental data are available.



1. INTRODUCTION

Liquid–liquid equilibrium (LLE) and the salting-out effect have been broadly studied as required knowledge in chemical engineering processes, biofuels, wastewater treatment, and pharmaceuticals because of their industrial relevance and economic advantages.^{1–9} Salting-out extraction systems composed of alcohols and salts are also commonly employed in many industrial processes for the separation of useful chemicals and fuels from aqueous solutions.^{10,11}

The addition of electrolytes to liquid mixtures can significantly influence the mutual solubility of components through the salting-out effect, thereby enhancing the phase separation and improving the extraction efficiency. For example, Pai and Rao¹² investigated the salt effect on the liquid–liquid equilibria of the water + ethanol + ethyl acetate system in the presence of saturated solutions of potassium acetate (KAc), sodium acetate (NaAc), potassium chloride (KCl), sodium chloride (NaCl), potassium sulfate (K_2SO_4), and sodium sulfate (Na_2SO_4) at 303.15 K. Their results indicated that K_2SO_4 caused the greatest solubility depression of water in the organic phase. Lin et al.¹³ studied the influence of adding electrolytes such as KAc or calcium chloride ($CaCl_2$) on the phase behavior of the water + ethanol + ethyl acetate mixture at temperatures ranging from 283.15 to 313.15 K.

They found that liquid–liquid phase splitting was significantly enhanced by the addition of these salts. Xie et al.¹⁰ examined the effect of several electrolytes—potassium carbonate (K_2CO_3), dipotassium phosphate (K_2HPO_4), tripotassium phosphate (K_3PO_4), and potassium pyrophosphate ($K_4P_2O_7$) on the water + ethanol system at 298 K. Their results demonstrated improved separation efficiency induced by the electrolytes: by salting-out, salts such as $K_4P_2O_7$ promote an almost complete separation of ethanol from water, leaving the ethanol nearly salt-free and concentrating the salts in the water-rich phase.

Although phase equilibrium data for alcohol–water systems with and without salts have been reported in the literature^{10,14–19} as summarized in Table 1, experimental data for quaternary systems containing standard salts (here: NaCl) remain limited. To the best of our knowledge, no liquid–liquid equilibrium (LLE) data are available for the

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Table 1. Phase Equilibrium Data of Water/Alcohol Systems with and without Salts Reported in the Literature

systems	phase behavior	T/K	references
water + ethanol	VLE	303–363	14
ethanol + isobutanol	VLE	351–381	19
water + ethanol + K ₂ CO ₃	LLE	298.15	10
water + ethanol + K ₂ HPO ₄	LLE	298.15	10
water + ethanol + K ₃ PO ₄	LLE	298.15	10
water + ethanol + K ₄ P ₂ O ₇	LLE	298.15	10
water + ethanol + CaCl ₂	VLE	298.15	16
water + ethanol + KAc	VLE	354–380	17
water + isobutanol + NaCl	LLE	298.13	15
	LLE	298.15	18

water + ethanol + isobutanol + NaCl system, which is investigated for the first time in the present work. In addition, for mixed-solvent electrolyte solutions, the experimental data from various sources might be inconsistent. Therefore, extensive data collection and new experimental measurements are necessary to establish a reliable database, improve thermodynamic models, and support the development of separation processes using salting-out effects.²⁰ The objective of the present study is to investigate the LLE behavior of the water + ethanol + isobutanol system with 5 and 10 wt % NaCl, at temperatures ranging from 293.15 to 313.15 K under atmospheric pressure. The experimental LLE tie-line data for the quaternary system (water + ethanol + isobutanol + NaCl) were correlated using the electrolyte Perturbed-Chain Statistical Associating Fluid Theory (ePC-SAFT)²¹ and eNRTL²² models. Additionally, the molecular interaction of water, ethanol, isobutanol, and NaCl was investigated by means of sigma profiles.

2. EXPERIMENTAL SECTION

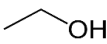
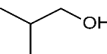
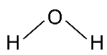
2.1. Materials. Ethanol (purity >0.998 mass fraction) and sodium chloride (NaCl, purity >0.995 mass fraction) were obtained from Fischer Chemical, while isobutanol (purity >0.99 mass fraction) was provided by Thermo Scientific. All chemicals were used as received from the suppliers. Deionized ultrapure water (resistivity: 18.3 MΩ·cm) was prepared in our laboratory using a NANO Pure-Ultrapure water system. Table 2 summarizes the materials used in this study.

2.2. Experimental Procedure. The tie-lines for LLE were measured using a glass-made equilibrium cell with an internal volume of approximately 25 cm³ at temperatures ranging from

293.15 to 313.15 K and at atmospheric pressure ($P = 0.1$ MPa) as described in our previous works.^{23,24} Thermostatic water from a circulating water bath was used to maintain the cell at a constant temperature with a standard uncertainty, $u(T)$, of ± 0.1 K. The temperature inside the cell was monitored with a precision thermometer (Model 1560, Hart Scientific Co.) with an uncertainty of ± 0.02 K. The liquid mixture was vigorously agitated with a magnetic stirrer. Different feed compositions of water + ethanol + NaCl were investigated. The aqueous feed was mixed with the extraction solvent (isobutanol) in a mass ratio of 1:1. The ethanol content in the aqueous feed was varied from 2 to 12 wt % at a fixed NaCl concentration of 5 wt % and from 1 to 5 wt % at a fixed NaCl concentration of 10 wt % (based on the total feed). The mixture of water + ethanol + isobutanol + NaCl was stirred in the equilibrium cell for 5 h and then allowed to settle for at least 12 h at 298.15 and 313.15 K until complete phase separation was achieved. Samples were then withdrawn from the two phases for analysis. The organic-rich phase was collected from the top opening of the cell using a syringe, while the water-rich phase was sampled from the bottom port to avoid cross-contamination. The equilibrium compositions were determined from three replicate samples of each phase.

2.3. Analytical Measurements. Samples from the organic (upper) and aqueous (lower) phases were analyzed using a gas chromatograph (GC, Model 1000, China Chromatography Co., Taiwan) equipped with a thermal conductivity detector (TCD). A stainless-steel column packed with Porapak Qs 80/100 (4 m length) was used, with high-purity helium (99.99%) as the carrier gas, to determine the equilibrium compositions of water, ethanol, and isobutanol in both phases. To prevent salt from entering the GC column, a stainless-steel tube filled with glass wool was installed at the column inlet and replaced when noticeable salt accumulation occurred. The injector and detector temperatures were set to 210 °C; the oven temperature was maintained at 200 °C, and the injection volume was 1 μL. Calibration curves were established before analysis. The NaCl concentrations in the organic- and aqueous-rich phases were determined gravimetrically. Approximately 1 mL of the liquid from each phase was divided into three vials. Each sample was evaporated in an oven at 105 °C until the NaCl mass remained constant. Three replicate measurements were performed for each phase.

Table 2. Description of Chemicals Used in This Study

Materials	Structure	CAS Number	Source	Purity in mass fraction ^a	MW (g/mol)
Ethanol		64-17-5	Fisher Chemical	> 0.998	46.07 ^a
Isobutanol		78-83-1	Thermo Scientific	> 0.99	74.12 ^a
Sodium Chloride	Na ⁺ Cl ⁻	7647-14-5	Fisher Chemical	> 0.995	58.44 ^a
Water (H ₂ O)		7732-18-5	Prepared in our Lab.	Deionized ultrapure water ^b	18.015 ^a

^aFrom supplier. ^bMilli-Q purification system with a resistivity of 18.3 MΩ·cm.

Table 3. Experimental LLE Tie-Line Data for Water (1) + Ethanol (2) + Isobutanol (3) + 5 wt % NaCl (4) System at Temperatures ($T = 293.15$ and 313.15 K) and Atmospheric Pressure ($P = 0.1$ MPa)^a

T (K)	organic phase (x_i)				aqueous phase (x_i)			
	x_1^I	x_2^I	x_3^I	x_4^I	x_1^{II}	x_2^{II}	x_3^{II}	x_4^{II}
293.15	0.3705	0.1624	0.4650	0.0021	0.9331	0.0159	0.0028	0.0482
	0.3703	0.1400	0.4880	0.0017	0.9404	0.0121	0.0027	0.0448
	0.3691	0.1144	0.5153	0.0012	0.9446	0.0110	0.0022	0.0422
	0.3695	0.0927	0.5366	0.0012	0.9486	0.0092	0.0037	0.0385
	0.3692	0.0759	0.5537	0.0012	0.9509	0.0073	0.0034	0.0384
	0.3685	0.0646	0.5658	0.0011	0.9539	0.0056	0.0034	0.0371
	0.3676	0.0478	0.5836	0.0010	0.9567	0.0044	0.0036	0.0353
	0.3641	0.0336	0.6015	0.0008	0.9580	0.0030	0.0037	0.0353
303.15	0.3906	0.1597	0.4480	0.0017	0.9345	0.0149	0.0025	0.0481
	0.3874	0.1371	0.4740	0.0015	0.9397	0.0124	0.0029	0.0450
	0.3887	0.1105	0.4995	0.0013	0.9437	0.0099	0.0036	0.0428
	0.3849	0.0885	0.5258	0.0008	0.9474	0.0081	0.0044	0.0401
	0.3821	0.0759	0.5410	0.0010	0.9489	0.0069	0.0049	0.0393
	0.3768	0.0623	0.5601	0.0008	0.9514	0.0055	0.0050	0.0381
	0.3753	0.0476	0.5767	0.0004	0.9550	0.0043	0.0041	0.0366
	0.3740	0.0316	0.5940	0.0004	0.9572	0.0026	0.0046	0.0356
313.15	0.4154	0.1313	0.4513	0.0020	0.9406	0.0122	0.0037	0.0435
	0.4130	0.1094	0.4759	0.0017	0.9426	0.0101	0.0041	0.0432
	0.4077	0.0866	0.5045	0.0012	0.9457	0.0079	0.0043	0.0421
	0.4091	0.0701	0.5192	0.0016	0.9497	0.0064	0.0042	0.0397
	0.4079	0.0577	0.5333	0.0011	0.9520	0.0051	0.0044	0.0385
	0.4013	0.0487	0.5489	0.0011	0.9536	0.0043	0.0045	0.0376
	0.3954	0.0342	0.5694	0.0010	0.9560	0.0029	0.0046	0.0365

^aStandard uncertainties are $u(T) = 0.02$ K, $u(P) = 0.001$ MPa, $u(x_i) = 0.0016$ (water), 0.0007 (ethanol), 0.0015 (isobutanol), and 0.0002 (NaCl).

Table 4. Experimental LLE Tie-Line Data for Water (1) + Ethanol (2) + Isobutanol (3) + 10 wt % NaCl (4) System at Temperatures ($T = 293.15$ – 313.15 K) and Atmospheric Pressure ($P = 0.1$ MPa)^a

T (K)	organic phase (x_i)				aqueous phase (x_i)			
	x_1^I	x_2^I	x_3^I	x_4^I	x_1^{II}	x_2^{II}	x_3^{II}	x_4^{II}
293.15	0.2456	0.0919	0.6612	0.0013	0.9223	0.0044	0.0013	0.0720
	0.2480	0.0767	0.6739	0.0014	0.9253	0.0033	0.0010	0.0704
	0.2476	0.0615	0.6896	0.0013	0.9277	0.0025	0.0013	0.0685
	0.2543	0.0383	0.7062	0.0012	0.9311	0.0014	0.0014	0.0661
	0.2560	0.0182	0.7248	0.0010	0.9353	0.0003	0.0001	0.0643
303.15	0.2587	0.0885	0.6521	0.0007	0.9235	0.0049	0.0015	0.0701
	0.2566	0.0735	0.6593	0.0006	0.9249	0.0038	0.0016	0.0697
	0.2632	0.0554	0.6811	0.0003	0.9280	0.0025	0.0016	0.0679
	0.2681	0.0359	0.6957	0.0003	0.9309	0.0014	0.0012	0.0665
	0.2736	0.0179	0.7078	0.0007	0.9363	0.0005	0.0003	0.0629
313.15	0.2684	0.1031	0.6268	0.0017	0.9210	0.0057	0.0013	0.0720
	0.2669	0.0954	0.6358	0.0019	0.9242	0.0042	0.0008	0.0708
	0.2693	0.0759	0.6535	0.0013	0.9271	0.0028	0.0008	0.0694
	0.2695	0.0615	0.6677	0.0013	0.9283	0.0022	0.0013	0.0682
	0.2733	0.0408	0.6845	0.0014	0.9295	0.0015	0.0014	0.0676
	0.2831	0.0176	0.6982	0.0011	0.9333	0.0005	0.0010	0.0652

^aStandard uncertainties are $u(T) = 0.02$ K, $u(P) = 0.001$ MPa, $u(x_i) = 0.0016$ (water), 0.0007 (ethanol), 0.0015 (isobutanol), and 0.0002 (NaCl).

3. RESULTS AND DISCUSSIONS

3.1. Tie-Line Data Measurement. The experimental LLE data of water (1) + ethanol (2) + isobutanol (3) with the presence of NaCl (4) were measured at temperature ranges from 293.15 to 313.15 K and at atmospheric pressure. To validate the experimental procedures, the LLE tie-line data of the ethanol + water + ethyl acetate + potassium acetate system were obtained at $T = 313.15$ K and at $P = 0.1$ MPa. The LLE tie-line data were compared with the results reported by Lin et

al.¹³ under the same conditions. The comparison shows satisfactory agreement, as illustrated in Figure S1 in the Supporting Information, confirming the reliability and precision of the measurements.

By using validated experimental procedures, the experimental LLE tie-line data of water (1) + ethanol (2) + isobutanol (3) with the presence of NaCl were investigated at temperature ranges from 293.15 to 313.15 K at $P = 0.1$ MPa. As shown in Tables 3 and 4, the solubility of ethanol decreases with increasing temperature. Increasing the NaCl

concentration up to 10 wt % induces the salting-out effect on solid–liquid–liquid equilibria (SLLE) phase behavior. Therefore, the tie-line data for 10 wt % are more limited compared to those for 5 wt % NaCl. The pseudoternary water (1) + ethanol (2) + isobutanol (3) + NaCl (4) system exhibits type-1 LLE behavior, as only one of the binary pairs (water + isobutanol) is partially miscible. At 313.15 K and at a fixed concentration of 10 wt % NaCl in the mixture, the solubility of water in isobutanol is 0.2831 in mole fraction, while the solubility of isobutanol in water is 0.0010 in mole fraction. Thus, the effect of adding NaCl on the mutual solubilities of water and isobutanol can provide useful insight into liquid-phase-splitting enhancement,¹³ as shown in Figure 1. The corresponding LLE

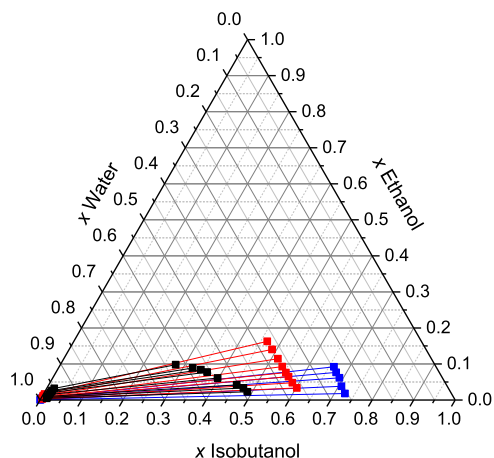


Figure 1. LLE for the system water + ethanol + isobutanol without and with NaCl at 293.15 K and atmospheric pressure expressed as salt-free composition: black (without NaCl), red (5 wt % NaCl), and blue (10 wt % NaCl).

data for water (1) + ethanol (2) + isobutanol (3) + 5 wt % NaCl (4) and water (1) + ethanol (2) + isobutanol (3) + 10 wt % NaCl (4) are presented in Figures 2–7.

3.2. Distribution Coefficient (*D*) and Separation Factor (*S*). The separation behavior between two alcohols (ethanol and isobutanol) in the aqueous system with present NaCl can be evaluated through their distribution coefficients

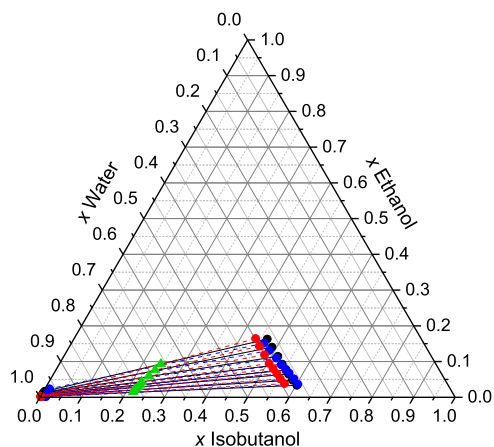


Figure 2. LLE for the system water + ethanol + isobutanol + 5 wt % NaCl at 293.15 K and atmospheric pressure expressed as salt-free composition: black (exp), red (ePC-SAFT), blue (eNRTL), and green (feed compositions).

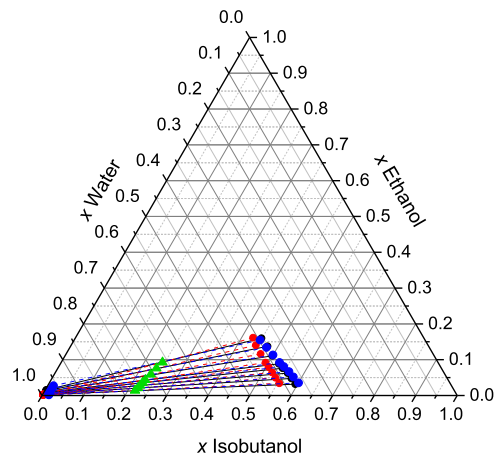


Figure 3. LLE for the system water + ethanol + isobutanol + 5 wt % NaCl at 303.15 K and atmospheric pressure expressed as salt-free composition: black (exp), red (ePC-SAFT), blue (eNRTL), and green (feed compositions).

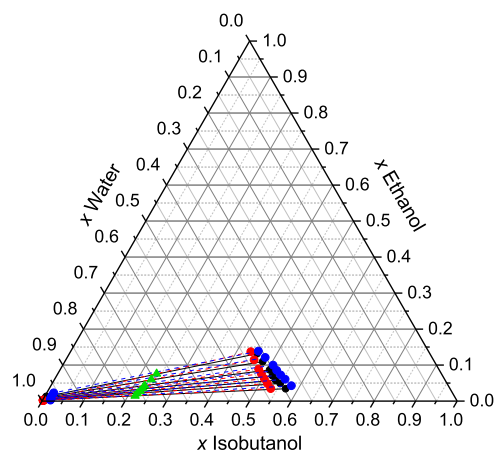


Figure 4. LLE for the system water + ethanol + isobutanol + 5 wt % NaCl at 313.15 K and atmospheric pressure expressed as salt-free composition: black (exp), red (ePC-SAFT), blue (eNRTL), and green (feed compositions).

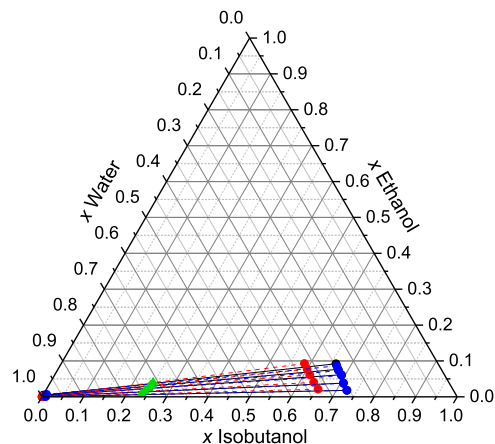


Figure 5. LLE for the system water + ethanol + isobutanol + 10 wt % NaCl at 293.15 K and atmospheric pressure expressed as salt-free composition: black (exp), red (ePC-SAFT), blue (eNRTL), and green (feed compositions).

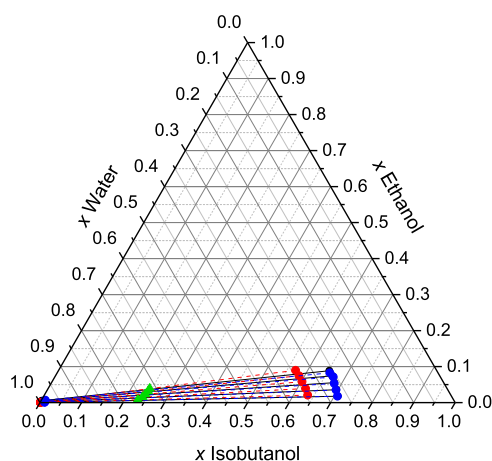


Figure 6. LLE for the system water + ethanol + isobutanol + 10 wt % NaCl at 303.15 K and atmospheric pressure expressed as salt-free composition: black (exp), red (ePC-SAFT), blue (eNRTL), and green (feed composition).

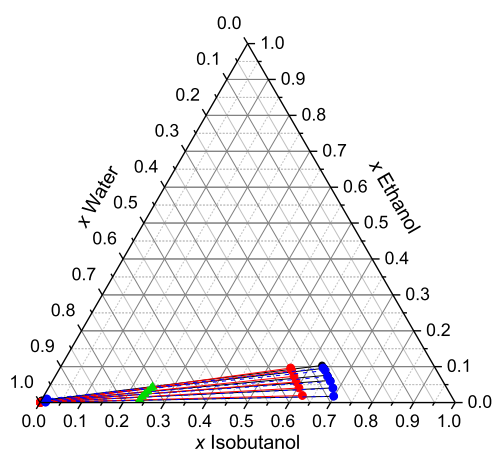


Figure 7. LLE for the system water + ethanol + isobutanol + 10 wt % NaCl at 313.15 K and atmospheric pressure expressed as salt-free composition: black (exp), red (ePC-SAFT), blue (eNRTL), and green (feed compositions).

(D) and separation factor (S). The separation factor is calculated from the ratio of the distribution coefficient of ethanol (D_2) to water (D_1), as expressed below

$$S = \frac{D_2}{D_1} = \frac{x_2^I/x_2^{II}}{x_1^I/x_1^{II}} \quad (1)$$

Superscripts I and II denote the organic and aqueous phases, respectively, while x_1 and x_2 represent the mole fractions of water and ethanol, respectively. The values of the distribution coefficient and the separation factor for the water + ethanol + isobutanol + NaCl system at each temperature are presented in Tables S1 and S2. As can be seen, both the distribution coefficients and separation factors are significantly greater than one (separation factors varying between 24.47 and 242.70), confirming that alcohols can be effectively separated from an aqueous solution. The experimental results indicate that the mixture containing 10 wt % NaCl has a high separation factor ($S = 61.87\text{--}242.71$), which shows the high ability of isobutanol to extract ethanol from water, as depicted in Figure 8. Increasing the NaCl concentration from 5 to 10 wt % strengthens the salting-out effect, thereby promoting liquid–

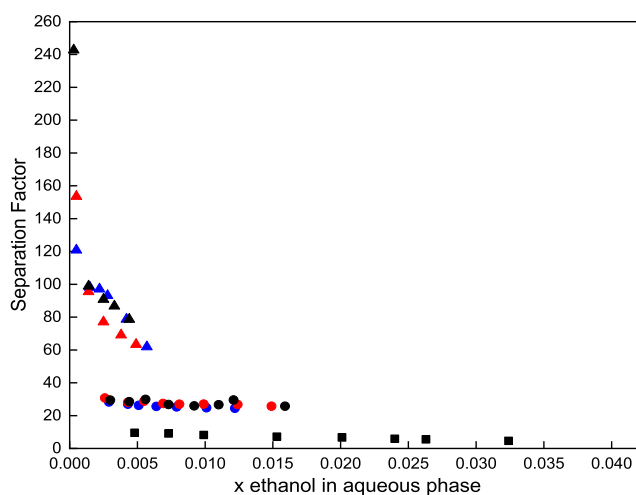


Figure 8. Separation factor of water over ethanol for the mixture water + ethanol + isobutanol + NaCl; black (293.15 K), red (303.15 K), blue (313.15 K), squares (without NaCl), circles (5 wt % NaCl), and triangles (10 wt % NaCl).

liquid phase splitting. The plots of distribution coefficients and separation factor versus the mole fraction of ethanol in the presence of NaCl at temperatures ranging from 293.15 to 313.15 K are shown in Figure 9.

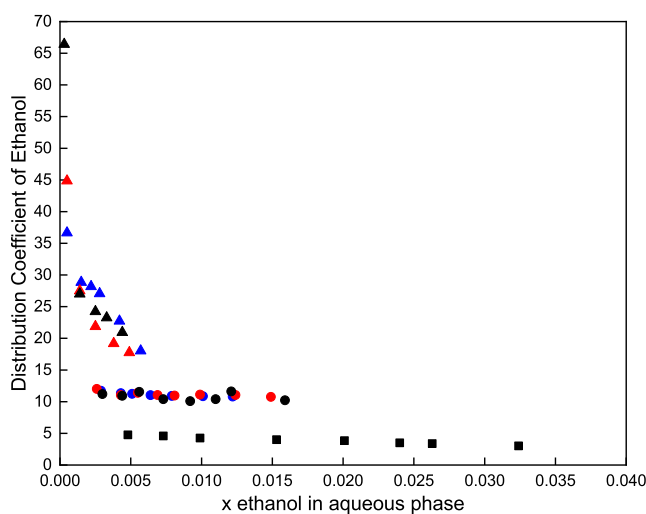


Figure 9. Distribution coefficient of ethanol over water of the mixture water + ethanol + isobutanol + NaCl; black (293.15 K), red (303.15 K), blue (313.15 K), squares (without NaCl), circles (5 wt % NaCl), and triangles (10 wt % NaCl).

It can be observed from Figures 8 and 9 that the distribution coefficients and separation factor increase with temperature from 293.15 to 303.15 K. The results clearly show that the salting-out effect of NaCl is very strong and increases the distribution coefficients and separation factor. In general, the addition of NaCl decreases the solubility of alcoholic compounds in the aqueous phase.^{10,25} This is also concluded from the data in Figures 8 and 9. Upon NaCl addition to the aqueous phase, the strong ion–dipole interactions between Na^+/Cl^- ions and water molecules decrease the interaction between water and ethanol.²⁶ Consequently, the ethanol molecule is preferentially distributed to the organic phase, leading to higher ethanol distribution coefficients and larger

Table 5. Pure-Component Parameters of All Solvents Used in This Work

organic solvent	water ³³	ethanol ²⁸	isobutanol ³⁴	Na ⁺³⁰	Cl ⁻³⁰
m_i^{seg}	1.2047	2.3827	2.8440		
$\sigma_i/\text{\AA}$	^a	3.1771	3.5561	2.8232	2.7560
$u_i/k_B/K$	353.95	198.24	257.13	230.00	170.00
$\epsilon^{\text{AiBi}}/k_B/K$	2425.7	2653.4	2514.3		
κ^{AiBi}	0.04509	0.03238	0.00391		
f_k	1.5	1.6	1.5		
$d_i^{\text{Born}}/\text{\AA}$				3.445	4.100

$$^a \sigma = 2.7927 + (10.11 \text{ e}^{-0.01775 \text{ T/K}} - 1.417 \text{ e}^{-0.01146 \text{ T/K}}).$$

separation factors. These results indicate that the recovery of ethanol from an aqueous solution by isobutanol in the presence of NaCl is highly favorable. The salting-out effect not only increases the extraction efficiency but also improves the selectivity. Higher temperatures are favorable for the thermodynamic efficiency, as well (but not necessarily for the energy requirements of the extraction-based process, which is not part of this work).

3.3. Correlation of LLE Tie-Line Data with ePC-SAFT and eNRTL. In this work, both ePC-SAFT and eNRTL were used to correlate the LLE data of the system water + ethanol + 2-butanol in the presence of NaCl. To describe charged species, ePC-SAFT was applied as an extension of the PC-SAFT equation of state (EoS). In PC-SAFT, the residual Helmholtz energy a^{res} is expressed as the sum of the hard-chain contribution a^{hc} , the dispersion contribution a^{disp} , and the association contribution a^{assoc} . Compared to the original PC-SAFT,^{27,28} ePC-SAFT^{29–32}, as well as the most recently developed version of ePC-SAFT,²¹ introduces two additional contributions for charged species: the Debye–Hückel contribution a^{DH} for ion–ion interactions and the Born contribution a^{Born} for ion–dipolar interactions. Therefore, the residual Helmholtz energy is given by the sum of these five contributions, as shown in eq 2

$$a^{\text{res}} = a^{\text{hc}} + a^{\text{disp}} + a^{\text{assoc}} + a^{\text{DH}} + a^{\text{Born}} \quad (2)$$

The original ePC-SAFT parameters include the segment number m_i^{seg} , the segment diameter σ_i , and the dispersion energy parameter u_i/k_B for nonassociating components, where k_B is the Boltzmann constant. Associating components additionally requires the association-energy parameter ϵ^{AiBi} and the association-volume parameter κ^{AiBi} . Furthermore, the binary interaction parameter (BIP) k_{ij} between each component pair can be adjusted to modify the dispersion energy of a pair ij in the mixture. The corresponding combining rule is given by eq 3

$$u_{ij} = \sqrt{u_i u_j} \cdot (1 - k_{ij}) \quad (3)$$

Additionally, the dielectric constant values of the solution are required to calculate a^{DH} and a^{Born} . The dielectric constant of electrolyte solutions depends on salt concentration, solvent composition, temperature, and pressure. In this work, the dielectric constant of solutions containing Na⁺ and Cl[−] ions was represented as the average of the available experimental data, represented by the following mixing rule.

$$\epsilon_{\text{r,mix}} = \frac{\epsilon_{\text{r,solvent,mix}}^{\text{salt-free}}}{1 + 7.01 \cdot x_{\text{ion}}} \quad (4)$$

To apply ePC-SAFT for correlating the LLE of the water + ethanol + isobutanol system in the presence of NaCl, pure-

component parameters, dielectric constants, and binary interaction parameters are required. The pure-component parameters are listed in Table 5, the relative dielectric constants of all components considered in this work are given in Table 6, and the ePC-SAFT binary interaction

Table 6. Relative Dielectric Constants for All the Components Used in This Work at 298.15 K and Atmospheric Pressure ($P = 0.1 \text{ MPa}$)

component	dielectric constant	references
water	78.09	35
ethanol	24.88	36
isobutanol	17.20	37
NaCl (Ions)	8	38

parameters between component pairs are presented in Table 7. The table also contains a parameter that is used in the most recent ePC-SAFT version, called f_k , cf. ePC-SAFT ref 21.

Table 7. ePC-SAFT Binary Interaction Parameters k_{ij} between Different Components Used in This Work^{a,b}

pair	k_{ij}	references
ethanol/water	−0.06167	39
ethanol/isobutanol	0.00154	19
ethanol/Na ⁺	0.05	31
ethanol/Cl [−]	0.8	31
water/isobutanol	−0.0071	34
water/Na ⁺	−0.3	31
water/Cl [−]	−0.3	31
isobutanol/Na ⁺	0	
isobutanol/Cl [−]	0	
Na ⁺ /Cl [−]	0.317	30

^aAll binary interaction parameters k_{ij} for the different components were taken from the literature. ^bOnly valid with the ePC-SAFT version from ref 21 and with the pure-component parameters from Table 5.

The eNRTL model has also been used to calculate the activity coefficients of the various species in the solutions, as given by

$$\frac{G^E}{RT} = \frac{G^{E,\text{PDH}}}{RT} + \frac{G^{E,\text{Born}}}{RT} + \frac{G^{E,\text{lc}}}{RT} \quad (5)$$

The long-range interaction contribution is represented by the Pitzer–Debye–Hückel's formula, which is normalized to mole fractions of unity for solvents and zero for electrolytes

$$\frac{G^{E,PDH}}{RT} = -\left(\sum_k x_k\right) \left(\frac{1000}{M_B}\right)^{0.5} \left(\frac{4A_\phi I_x}{\rho}\right) \ln(1 + \rho I_x^{0.5}) \quad (6)$$

$$\frac{G^{E,Born}}{RT} = \frac{Q_e^2}{RT} \left(\frac{1}{\epsilon} - \frac{1}{\epsilon_w}\right) \left(\frac{\sum_i x_i z_i^2}{r_i}\right) 10^{-2} \quad (7)$$

$$A_\phi = \frac{1}{3} \left(\frac{2\pi N_A d}{1000}\right)^{0.5} \left(\frac{Q_e^2}{\epsilon_w kT}\right)^{0.5} \quad (8)$$

where x_k is the mole fraction of component k , M_B is the molecular weight of the solvent B, A_ϕ is Debye–Hückel's parameter, I_x is the ionic strength in mole fraction, Q_e is the electron charge, ϵ_w is the dielectric constant of water, d is the density of solvent, k is the Boltzmann constant, r_i is Born's radius, and T is the temperature.

$$\ln \gamma_i = \ln \gamma_i^{PDH} + \ln \gamma_i^{Born} + \ln \gamma_i^{lc,m} \quad (9)$$

$$\ln \gamma_i^{PDH} = -\left(\frac{1000}{M_B}\right)^{0.5} A_\phi \left[\left(\frac{2z_i^2}{\rho}\right) \ln(1 + \rho I_x^{0.5}) + \frac{z_i^2 I_x^{0.5} - 2I_x^{0.5}}{1 + \rho I_x^{0.5}}\right] \quad (10)$$

$$\ln \gamma_i^{Born} = \frac{Q_e^2}{2kT} \left(\frac{1}{\epsilon} - \frac{1}{\epsilon_w}\right) \left(\frac{\sum_i x_i z_i^2}{r_i}\right) 10^{-2} \quad (11)$$

$$\ln \gamma_i^{lc,m} = 2 \left[\frac{y^2 \pm G_{21} \tau_{21}}{(y \pm y_2 G_{21})^2} - \frac{y \pm y_2 G_{12} \tau_{12}}{(2y \pm y_2 G_{12})^2} + \frac{y \pm G_{12} \tau_{12}}{(2y \pm y_2 G_{12})} \right] \quad (12)$$

Table 8 shows the optimized binary interaction parameters (BIPs) of eNRTL of water–ethanol, water–isobutanol, and

Table 8. Binary Interaction Parameters (BIPs)^a of eNRTL for the System Water (1) + Ethanol (2) + Isobutanol (3) + NaCl (4) at 293.15–313.15 K and Atmospheric Pressure ($P = 0.1$ MPa)

component (ij)	b_{ij} (K)	b_{ji} (K)	α
1–2	−404.067	1823.31	0.2
1–3	1271.07	−150.629	0.2
1–4	−35,373.9	−1471.08	0.2
2–3	−658.804	92.8789	0.2
2–4	68,085.7	36,654.7	0.2
3–4	2345.56	44,854	0.2

^aBIPs by experimental data regression.

water–NaCl obtained in this work. Figures 2–7 correspond to the experimental LLE tie-line measurements with the correlated results from the ePC-SAFT and eNRTL models for the water + ethanol + isobutanol system at NaCl concentrations of 5 and 10 wt % over the temperature range of 293.15–313.15 K at atmospheric pressure. The average absolute deviations (AADs) for the ePC-SAFT and eNRTL models are listed in Tables 9 and 10. From Figures 2–7 and the AAD values, it can be observed that the agreement

between the experimental and the correlated results is satisfactory. However, the ePC-SAFT model represents the experimental LLE tie-line measurements of the water + ethanol + isobutanol system more accurately at 5 wt % NaCl than at 10 wt % NaCl. For comparison purposes, the optimized BIPs were also compared with those from the Aspen Plus databank V.14 (APV140 VLE-LIT) for water–ethanol, water–isobutanol, and ethanol–isobutanol binary systems. The comparison results are presented in Tables S3 and S4 and Figures S2 and S3. The regression of all parameters from the experimental data yields smaller AADs than available BIPs. A relatively high deviation was found for water + ethanol + isobutanol + 10 wt % NaCl.

Figures 5–7 show the calculated values in good agreement with the experimental data compared to those in Figure S3.

3.4. Quantum Chemical Calculations. The surface charge distribution of the molecule is represented by the sigma profile, which can be employed to assess intermolecular interactions. Hydrogen bonding energies of NaCl, water, ethanol, and isobutyl alcohol, as well as electrostatic energy differences, are illustrated in Figure 10. The B3LYP functional and the 6–31G* basis set were employed to optimize the molecular geometry using DFT theory. Subsequently, the molecular structure file was generated using the optimized structure. The σ -profile of ethanol exhibited four distinct peaks, with the majority of these peaks located in the nonpolar region ($\sigma = -0.004, 0.002 \text{ e}\cdot\text{\AA}^{-2}$), hydrogen bond acceptor region ($\sigma = 0.017 \text{ e}\cdot\text{\AA}^{-2}$), and hydrogen bond donor ($\sigma = -0.016 \text{ e}\cdot\text{\AA}^{-2}$). The miscibility of water and ethanol has a highly strong interaction in these three regions. The ionic interaction from NaCl induces strong interactions in the hydrogen bond donor and the hydrogen bond acceptor regions. As a result of the polar nature of water, NaCl is more soluble in water, which facilitates ionization. Isobutanol is significantly less polar, which fails to solvate ions, compared to water.

4. CONCLUSIONS

LLE data for the pseudoternary system of water (1) + ethanol (2) + isobutanol (3) in the presence of NaCl (4) with two different concentrations, 5 and 10 wt %, respectively, were measured at temperature ranges from 293.15 to 313.15 K at atmospheric pressure. The addition of NaCl to the mixtures increased the heterogeneous region. Increasing the NaCl concentration from 5 to 10 wt % intensified the salting-out effect and promoted liquid–liquid phase separation. For example, compared with the salt-free system, the presence of 10 wt % NaCl increased the separation factor by up to 25 times and the distribution coefficient by up to 14 times. These findings demonstrate that the salting-out effect improves not only the extraction efficiency but also selectivity. The measured LLE data were further used to validate the applicability of ePC-SAFT and eNRTL for modeling the investigated systems. The sigma profiles indicated the molecular interaction of water, ethanol, isobutyl alcohol, and NaCl. Based on the sigma profiles, a strong interaction of water and NaCl could be concluded, which induces the separation factor of the considered system water + ethanol + isobutanol, with improvements in phase-splitting of the liquid–liquid mixture. Regression of all BIPs using the eNRTL model requires 13 parameters, while the ePC-SAFT model predicts the electrolyte-aqueous ethanol + isobutanol solution with 7 parameters. Using fewer BIPs, ePC-SAFT predicted electrolyte-aqueous water + isobutyl alcohol phase splitting. With available

Table 9. AAD of LLE Tie-Line Data Correlation with ePC-SAFT and eNRTL Models for the Quaternary System of Water (1) + Ethanol (2) + Isobutanol (3) + 5 wt % NaCl (4) at Elevated Temperatures 293.15–313.15 K and Atmospheric Pressure ($P = 0.1$ MPa)

T/K	model	phase	Δx_1^a	Δx_2^a	Δx_3^a	Δx_4^a	grand AAD ^b
			AAD	AAD	AAD	AAD	
293.15	ePC-SAFT	organic	0.0287	0.0031	0.0313	0.0009	0.0161
		aqueous	0.0482	0.0064	0.0021	0.0083	
	eNRTL	organic	0.0059	0.0048	0.0010	0.0011	0.0046
		aqueous	0.0102	0.0025	0.0080	0.0029	
303.15	ePC-SAFT	organic	0.0305	0.0027	0.0336	0.0005	0.0168
		aqueous	0.0495	0.0061	0.0026	0.0088	
	eNRTL	organic	0.0053	0.0040	0.0015	0.0007	0.0047
		aqueous	0.0120	0.0029	0.0097	0.0012	
313.15	ePC-SAFT	organic	0.0245	0.0033	0.0276	0.0006	0.0203
		aqueous	0.0487	0.0052	0.0025	0.0081	
	eNRTL	organic	0.0147	0.0117	0.0041	0.0011	0.0078
		aqueous	0.0128	0.0030	0.0126	0.0027	

$$^a \Delta x_i = \sum_{k=1}^{n_{TL}} |x_{ik}^{calc} - x_{ik}^{expt}| / n_{TL} \quad ^b \text{grand AAD} = \left[\sum_{k=1}^{n_{TL}} \sum_{j=1}^2 \sum_{i=1}^3 |x_{ijk}^{calc} - x_{ijk}^{expt}| \right] / 8n_{TL}, \text{ where } n_{TL} \text{ is the number of tie-lines.}$$

Table 10. AAD of LLE Tie-Line Data Correlation with ePC-SAFT and eNRTL Models for the Quaternary System of Water (1) + Ethanol (2) + Isobutanol (3) + 10 wt % NaCl (4) at Elevated Temperatures 293.15–313.15 K and Atmospheric Pressure ($P = 0.1$ MPa)

T/K	model	phase	Δx_1^a	Δx_2^a	Δx_3^a	Δx_4^a	grand AAD ^b
			AAD	AAD	AAD	AAD	
293.15	ePC-SAFT	organic	0.0729	0.0096	0.0739	0.0005	0.0342
		aqueous	0.0975	0.0020	0.0007	0.0161	
	eNRTL	organic	0.0010	0.0026	0.0022	0.0007	0.0086
		aqueous	0.0312	0.0008	0.0062	0.0241	
303.15	ePC-SAFT	organic	0.0760	0.0021	0.0774	0.0005	0.0341
		aqueous	0.0973	0.0023	0.0008	0.0165	
	eNRTL	organic	0.0011	0.0022	0.0033	0.0022	0.0083
		aqueous	0.0289	0.0006	0.0079	0.0204	
313.15	ePC-SAFT	organic	0.0801	0.0039	0.0783	0.0002	0.0357
		aqueous	0.1021	0.0025	0.0003	0.0179	
	eNRTL	organic	0.0011	0.0035	0.0028	0.0004	0.0091
		aqueous	0.0323	0.0020	0.0098	0.0205	

$$^a \Delta x_i = \sum_{k=1}^{n_{TL}} |x_{ik}^{calc} - x_{ik}^{expt}| / n_{TL} \quad ^b \text{grand AAD} = \left[\sum_{k=1}^{n_{TL}} \sum_{j=1}^2 \sum_{i=1}^3 |x_{ijk}^{calc} - x_{ijk}^{expt}| \right] / 8n_{TL}, \text{ where } n_{TL} \text{ is the number of tie-lines.}$$

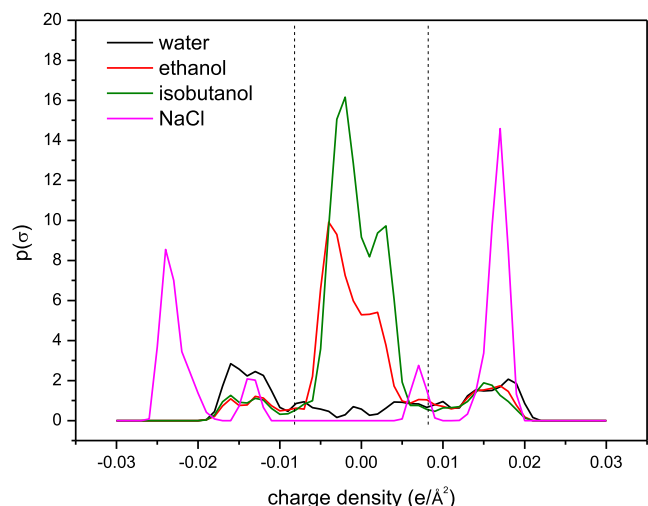


Figure 10. Sigma profile (σ) with the segmented surface for water, ethanol, isobutanol, and NaCl.

experimental data of electrolyte-aqueous water + isobutanol, the ePC-SAFT successfully predicted the phase splitting, which improved the accuracy of the ePC-SAFT for electrolyte predictions. The LLE data obtained in this work can be applied in chemical engineering processes, such as ethanol extraction from fermentation broths or ethanol regeneration from industrial process solutions using salting-out effects. This information provides guidance for the process design and optimization.

■ ASSOCIATED CONTENT

Supporting Information

The Supporting Information is available free of charge at <https://pubs.acs.org/doi/10.1021/acs.jced.5c00780>.

Distribution and separation factor of water + ethanol + isobutanol + NaCl, AAD of LLE tie-line data correlation for water + ethanol + isobutanol + NaCl, and plots of comparison experimental with literature for LLE of ethanol + water + ethyl acetate + potassium acetate and LLE of water + ethanol + isobutanol + NaCl (PDF)

AUTHOR INFORMATION

Corresponding Authors

Christoph Held – Laboratory of Thermodynamics, Department of Biochemical and Chemical Engineering, Technische Universität Dortmund, 44225 Dortmund, Germany; orcid.org/0000-0003-1074-177X; Email: christoph.held@tu-dortmund.de

Ardila Hayu Tiwikrama – Chemical Engineering and Biotechnology Department, National Taipei University of Technology, Taipei 10608, Taiwan; orcid.org/0000-0002-0393-6774; Email: ardilahayu@mail.ntut.edu.tw

Authors

Salal Hasan Khudaida – Laboratory of Thermodynamics, Department of Biochemical and Chemical Engineering, Technische Universität Dortmund, 44225 Dortmund, Germany; Chemical Engineering and Biotechnology Department, National Taipei University of Technology, Taipei 10608, Taiwan

Serli Dwi Rahayu – Chemical Engineering and Biotechnology Department, National Taipei University of Technology, Taipei 10608, Taiwan

Paul Figiel – Laboratory of Thermodynamics, Department of Biochemical and Chemical Engineering, Technische Universität Dortmund, 44225 Dortmund, Germany; orcid.org/0000-0002-5947-7247

Complete contact information is available at: <https://pubs.acs.org/10.1021/acs.jced.5c00780>

Author Contributions

S.H.K.: conceptualization, formal analysis, methodology, writing—original draft, writing—review and editing, validation, software, and supervision. S.D.R.: data curation, formal analysis, investigation, and software. P.F.: formal analysis and software. C.H. and A.H.T.: conceptualization, funding acquisition, methodology, validation, project administration, writing—review and editing, and supervision.

Notes

The authors declare no competing financial interest.

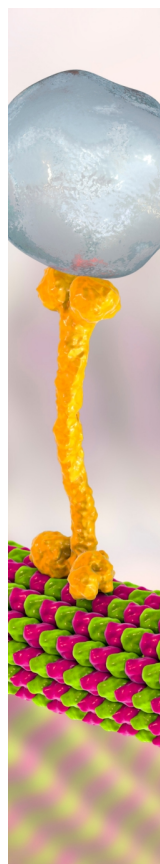
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